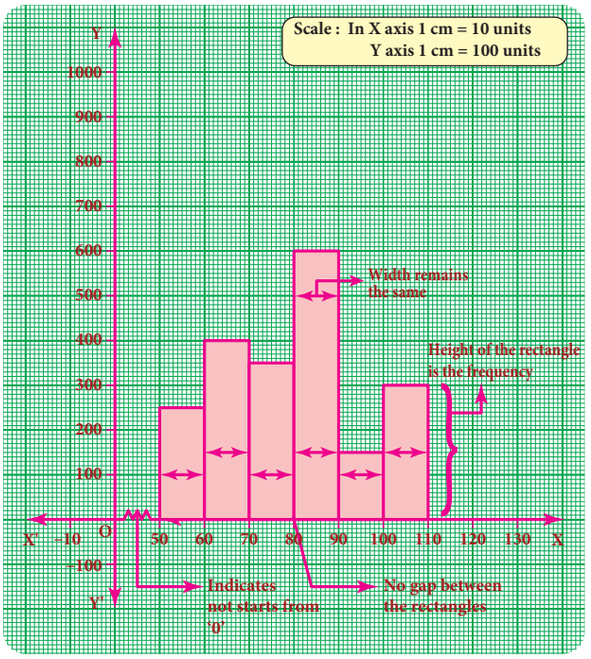
6.4.1 Histogram

A histogram is a graph of a continuous frequency distribution. Histogram contains a set of rectangles, the base of which is the length of the class interval and the frequency in each class interval is its height. i.e the class intervals are represented on the horizontal axis (x- axis) and the frequencies are represented on the vertical axis (y-axis).

The area of each rectangle is proportional to the frequency in the respective class interval and the total area of the histogram is proportional to the total frequency. Because of the continuous frequency distribution, the rectangles are placed continuously side by side with no gap between adjacent rectangles.



Steps to construct a Histogram:

1. Represent the data in the continuous form (exclusive form) if it is in discontinuous form (inclusive form) by converting it using the adjustment factor.
2. Select the appropriate units along the x-axis and y-axis.
3. Plot the lower limits of all class interval on the x –axis.
4. Plot the frequencies of the distribution on the y – axis.
5. Construct the rectangles with class intervals as bases and corresponding frequencies as heights. Each class has lower and upper values. This gives us two equal vertical lines representing the frequencies. The upper ends of the lines are joined together and this process will give us rectangles.

Note

Differences between a Bar graph and a Histogram

	Bar graph	Histogram
1	Used for Ungrouped data	Used for Grouped data
2	Gap between the bars	No gap between rectangles
3	Height of each bar is important and not its width	Height and width of each rectangle are equally important

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